

Getting Started Guide

Complete walkthrough of TTC Estimator — setup, features, and everything you need to win more bids.

Top Trade Contractor · Powered by XpertAISolution.com

'& All Plans'

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1. Welcome to TTC Estimator

What Is TTC Estimator?

TTC Estimator is a professional contractor estimating and CRM platform built by Top Trade Contractor (powered by XpertAISolution.com). It is designed specifically for trade contractors — painters, roofers, concrete specialists, electricians, plumbers, fence installers, and more — who need to produce accurate, professional estimates quickly and manage their client relationships in one place.

Every user has a completely private, isolated account. Your clients, estimates, pricing, and company data are never visible to other users on the platform.

Free Plan — What's Included

Your free account includes everything you need to get started:

- Up to 3 estimates (upgrade for unlimited)
- All 18 project types with auto-populated cost formulas
- PDF export for professional client quotes
- Contractor View (full cost breakdown with margins)
- Client Quote View (clean pricing only)
- 3-Tier pricing — Conservative, Standard, Premium
- Company Settings (logo, contact info, payment terms)
- Print-ready output

TIP

Upgrade to Pro for unlimited estimates, Word export, full CRM functionality, and more — all for \$29/month.

2. Creating Your Account

Sign Up Steps

1

Go to the TTC Estimator website

Navigate to xpertaisolution.com (or your assigned app URL). You will see the landing page with a "Create Account" tab on the right side of the screen.

2

Click "Create Account"

On the right panel, click the "Create Account" tab to switch from Sign In to the signup form.

3

Enter your full name

Type your first and last name in the Full Name field. This is how your name will appear throughout the app.

4

Enter your email address

Use a valid email address — this is your login and where we send important updates and your guide files.

5

Create a strong password

Your password must be at least 6 characters. Use a mix of letters, numbers, and symbols for security.

6

Click "Create Account"

Tap the blue "Create Account" button. You will see a success message asking you to check your email.

Email Confirmation

After signing up, TTC sends an automated confirmation email to verify your address. You must confirm your email before you can log in.

1

Open your email inbox

Look for an email from TTC Estimator / XpertAISolution.com. Check your Spam or Junk folder if you do not see it within 2 minutes.

2

Click "Confirm your email"

Click the confirmation link in the email. You will be redirected back to the app and automatically signed in.

3

Receive your Getting Started guide

Upon confirmation, this Getting Started PDF guide and your plan guide are automatically sent to your email for reference.

& NOTE

The confirmation link expires after 24 hours. If it expires, go back to the sign-in page, enter your credentials, and request a new link using "Forgot password?" or contact support.

3. The Onboarding Wizard

The first time you sign in after confirming your email, you are taken through a 3-step setup wizard. This collects your personal and business details so TTC can personalize your experience and auto-fill your estimates and invoices.

!9 INFO

The wizard takes about 2–3 minutes. All fields marked with an asterisk (*) are required. You can always update this information later in Company Settings.

Step 1 — Personal Information

This step collects your personal contact details:

- First Name* — Your first name
- Last Name* — Your last name
- Phone Number* — Your personal or business contact number (used on estimates)
- Address — Your personal or business street address
- City, State, ZIP — Your location for estimate templates

TIP

Click the "Continue" button after filling in the required fields to advance to the next step. Use "Back" to return to a previous step at any time.

Step 2 — Business Details

Enter your business information. This appears on all estimates and client-facing documents:

- Business Type* — Select your trade from the dropdown (Painting, Roofing, Concrete, Electrical, Plumbing, Fencing, Landscaping, HVAC, Flooring, Drywall, Masonry, Carpentry, Tile & Stone, Insulation, Siding, Windows & Doors, General Contractor, Other)
- Business Name* — Your company's legal or operating name (e.g., "Smith Contracting LLC")
- Business Address — Your company's mailing or physical address
- Business City, State, ZIP — Used for invoice headers
- Business Phone* — Your main business phone number
- Business Email — Your business contact email (customers reply to this)
- Website — Your company website URL (optional)

Step 3 — Branding & Logo

Upload your company logo and add any additional business details:

- Business Logo — Click the upload area to select an image (PNG, JPG, or SVG). Max 5 MB. Your logo appears on PDF exports and the app header.
- Business Details — A free-text field for taglines, specialties, certifications, or any other info you want on quotes (e.g., "Licensed & Insured · 20 years experience").
- License Number — Your contractor license number (appears on quotes for credibility).

- Insurance — Your insurance provider or policy number (optional but recommended for professionalism).

1

Click "Finish Setup"

After completing Step 3, click "Finish Setup" to save your information. You will be taken directly to the Estimator.

!9 INFO

All the information you enter flows automatically into every new estimate, invoice header, and PDF export. You never have to type your company info again.

4. Navigating the App

Top Navigation Bar

The navigation bar at the top of every page contains:



- TTC Logo (top-left) — Click to return to the Estimator page from anywhere in the app.
- Estimator tab — Opens the main estimating workspace where you create and manage quotes.
- CRM tab — Opens the Client Relationship Manager to track clients, leads, and projects.
- Admin tab (admin accounts only) — Opens the Admin Command Center for managing all users and billing.
- User Menu (top-right, your initials) — Click to view your account email and sign out.

Estimator Tab

The Estimator is the core of TTC. It is split into two panels:

- Left Panel — The form where you enter all estimate details (client info, project type, measurements, materials, labor, overhead, and notes).
- Right Panel (desktop only) — Live results that update in real-time as you fill in the form, showing cost breakdowns and client-ready quotes.
- On mobile — Toggle between "Contractor View" and "Client View" using the buttons at the bottom of the screen.

CRM Tab

The CRM (Client Relationship Manager) is your central hub for managing relationships:

- Client list — Every client and lead you have ever added, with status, last contact, and project value.
- Client profiles — Click any client to see their full history, estimates, notes, and contact details.
- Pipeline statuses — Mark clients as Prospect, Active, Completed, On-Hold, or Declined.
- Notes — Add timestamped notes to any client record.

5. Creating an Estimate

Every new estimate starts fresh. Click the "+ New Estimate" button in the header to reset the form, or simply start filling in the fields on the left panel.

Client Information

The "Client Information" section is always expanded at the top of the left panel. Fill in:

- Client Name* — The name of the person or company you are quoting.
- Company — The client's company name (if applicable; leave blank for residential).
- Address — The client's billing address.
- City, State, ZIP — Used on the client quote view.
- Phone — Client's contact phone (optional but useful for follow-up).
- Email — Client's email address.

TIP

Client information appears on all PDF exports in the "Prepared For:" section. Fill this in carefully as clients will see it on their quote.

Project Type & Sub-Type

The "Project Type" section is one of TTC's most powerful features. It auto-populates your materials, labor, and overhead based on industry-standard formulas.

1 Click "Select project type"

A grid of 18 project category cards appears. Each card shows an icon and the project name.

2 Select your trade category

Click the card that matches your project (e.g., "Painting", "Concrete", "Roofing"). The card highlights in indigo when selected.

3 Select a sub-type

After choosing a category, a second row of sub-types appears below (e.g., for Painting: Interior Walls, Exterior Siding, Cabinet Refinishing, Deck/Fence Staining, etc.).

4 Add a project description

Use the free-text "Project Description" field to describe the specific scope (e.g., "2-story colonial, full exterior paint, includes trim and shutters").

5 Add the job address

Enter the physical address where the work will be performed. This appears on the quote and is separate from the client's billing address.

& FEATURE

TTC includes 18 main project categories with detailed sub-types: Painting, Concrete, Fencing, Roofing, Electrical, Plumbing, Landscaping, HVAC, Flooring, Drywall, Masonry, Carpentry, Tile & Stone, Insulation, Siding, Windows & Doors, General Contracting, and Custom.

Measurements

After selecting a sub-type, a "Measurements" section appears with input fields specific to your project type. These drive all calculations.

- Each measurement field has a label (e.g., "Square Footage", "Linear Feet", "Number of Stories") and a unit.
- Enter the actual measured values from your site visit or blueprint.
- After entering measurements, click "Re-calculate materials & labor from measurements"
- All quantities are calculated automatically using built-in industry formulas — no manual math required.

TIP

Always measure carefully. The formulas include standard waste factors and coverage rates, but entering accurate field measurements is critical for profitable quotes.

Materials, Labor & Overhead

These three sections form the financial backbone of your estimate.

Materials Table

Auto-populated from your measurements. Each row includes:

- Category — Type of material (e.g., Paint, Lumber, Concrete)
- Item Name — Specific material or product
- Quantity — Calculated from your measurements
- Unit — Unit of measure (gallon, sheet, bag, linear ft, etc.)
- Unit Cost (\$) — Your material cost per unit
- Markup % — Your markup on this material (default from Settings)
- Notes — Optional notes about the material or supplier
- + Add Material — Click to add custom items not in the auto-populated list
- Trash icon — Remove any line item you do not need

Labor Table

Auto-populated with labor tasks for your selected sub-type:

- Task Description — What labor activity this covers
- Workers — Number of workers for this task
- Hours — Estimated hours (calculated from measurements)
- Rate/Hour (\$) — Hourly rate per worker
- Notes — Notes about this labor item
- + Add Labor — Add custom labor items

Overhead & Equipment

Covers non-material, non-labor project costs:

- Description — What the overhead covers (e.g., Equipment rental, Permits, Dumpster, Travel)
- Cost (\$) — Fixed dollar amount for this overhead item

- + Add Overhead — Add custom overhead items

& NOTE

Do not forget overhead items like permit fees, equipment rental, disposal, and travel. These are often overlooked and can significantly impact your profitability.

Scope of Work & Notes

The "Scope of Work & Notes" section (collapsed by default — click the header to expand) contains three text fields:

- Scope of Work — A detailed description of exactly what is included in this estimate. This appears on the client quote and defines your contractual obligations.
- Exclusions — Clearly state what is NOT included (e.g., "Does not include drywall repair", "Excludes electrical work"). This protects you from scope creep.
- Internal Notes — Private notes visible only to you in the Contractor View. Never shown to clients. Use for reminders, supplier contacts, or special instructions.

6. Reading Your Results

The right panel (or the bottom toggle on mobile) shows your live estimate results. Toggle between two views using the tabs at the top of the right panel:

Contractor View

Client Quote View

Contractor View

The Contractor View is for your eyes only. It shows your full financial breakdown:

- Material Cost — Total raw material cost (before markup)
- Material with Markup — Materials after your markup percentage is applied
- Labor Cost — Total labor (workers × hours × rate)
- Overhead — Total overhead and equipment costs
- Total Direct Cost — Sum of all costs before margin
- Gross Margin % — Your target profit margin
- Final Quote Prices — For all three pricing tiers (Conservative, Standard, Premium)
- Per-Tier Profit — Exact dollar profit at each pricing tier

!9 INFO

The margin controls in the Contractor View let you adjust the three pricing tiers on the fly. Drag the sliders or type new values to instantly see how it affects your quote price and profit.

Client Quote View

The Client Quote View shows a clean, professional document that your client receives. It includes:

- Your company logo, name, address, and contact details
- Client name and project address
- Estimate number and validity date
- Three pricing options — Conservative, Standard, and Premium
- Scope of Work and Exclusions
- Payment terms and warranty
- A professional signature / acceptance line

' TIP

Presenting 3 pricing tiers is a proven sales technique. Most clients choose the middle (Standard) option, which is often your best margin tier.

3-Tier Pricing Explained

TTC automatically calculates three quote prices from your costs:

- Conservative — Your lowest quote using the minimum margin setting. Use this to win highly competitive bids.

- Standard — Your middle quote using your standard margin. This should be your default recommendation to clients.
- Premium — Your highest quote using the maximum margin setting. Appropriate for complex jobs, premium clients, or when you are at full capacity.

You control the margin percentages for each tier in Company Settings (defaulting to 55% / 60% / 65%). The selected tier at time of PDF export determines which price appears on the client quote.

7. Exporting Your Estimate

The Export Bar at the bottom of the screen (or bottom of the right panel on desktop) contains all export options:

PDF Export

1 Select your pricing tier

In the Contractor View, click the tier radio button (Conservative, Standard, or Premium) you want reflected on the client quote.

2 Choose your view

Click "Contractor View" to export the full internal breakdown, or "Client View" to export the clean client-facing version.

3 Click "PDF"

The PDF button in the Export Bar generates and downloads a professional PDF instantly.

!9 INFO

The PDF Contractor View includes all cost details, margins, and internal notes. The Client PDF is clean — it only shows the quote price, scope, terms, and your branding.

Print

1 Click "Print"

Opens your browser's print dialog. The app automatically applies print-friendly CSS — navigation bars and internal tools are hidden.

2 Select destination

Choose your printer or "Save as PDF" to save directly from the browser's built-in PDF exporter.

8. Saving & Managing Estimates

Auto-Save

TTC automatically saves your current estimate every 30 seconds to local storage. You will never lose work mid-session due to an accidental refresh or browser close.

Manual Save

Click the "Save" button in the Export Bar or the "Save" button in the header at any time to immediately save your current estimate.

Viewing Saved Estimates

1

Click "Saved Estimates"

Click the clock/history icon or "Saved Estimates" button in the top header.

2

Browse your estimate list

A drawer opens from the right showing all your saved estimates sorted by date. Each row shows: Estimate #, Client Name, Project Type, Quote Amount, and Status.

3

Load an estimate

Click any estimate to load it back into the form. All fields, measurements, materials, and settings are restored exactly as saved.

4

Delete an estimate

Click the trash icon next to any saved estimate to permanently delete it. This action cannot be undone.

Estimate Statuses

- Draft — Estimate is being worked on, not yet sent to a client.
- Sent — Estimate has been sent to the client for review.
- Accepted — Client has accepted the quote. Ready to convert to invoice.
- Declined — Client declined the quote.

TIP

Free plan users are limited to 3 saved estimates. When you reach the limit, you will be prompted to upgrade to Pro for unlimited estimates.

Converting to Invoice

Once a client accepts a quote, click the "Convert to Invoice" button in the header. This changes the document type from "Estimate" to "Invoice" and updates the status automatically. The invoice keeps all the same line items and pricing.

9. Company Settings

Company Settings is where you configure all the details that appear on your estimates and invoices. Access it by clicking the Settings (gear) icon in the top header or through the user menu.

Company Information

- Company Name — Your legal or trade name (appears at the top of all documents)
- Owner Name — Your name as it appears on signature lines
- Address, City, State, ZIP — Your company address for document headers
- Phone — Business phone for client contact
- Email — Business email address
- Website — Your website URL
- License # — Your contractor license number
- Insurance — Your insurance details
- Logo — Upload or replace your company logo (PNG/JPG, max 2MB)

Default Financial Settings

These defaults populate every new estimate automatically:

- Default Material Markup % — Your standard markup on all materials (default: 30%)
- Conservative Margin % — Your minimum profit margin for the low-tier price (default: 55%)
- Standard Margin % — Your target profit margin for the mid-tier price (default: 60%)
- Premium Margin % — Your maximum margin for the high-tier price (default: 65%)
- Tax Rate % — Sales tax to apply to materials (default: 0%)
- Currency — USD, CAD, MXN, etc.

Default Document Settings

- Payment Terms — Default payment terms text (e.g., "50% deposit required to schedule. Balance due upon completion.").
- Warranty — Your standard warranty statement (e.g., "1-year warranty on all labor.").
- Quote Validity Days — How many days the quote is valid (default: 30 days). Appears on client quote as "Valid until [date]".

TIP

Setting accurate default margins and markups is the single most important thing you can do to protect your profitability. Review these numbers carefully before creating your first client estimate.

10. The CRM — Managing Clients

The CRM (Client Relationship Manager) tab keeps every client, lead, and project organized in one place. Access it by clicking "CRM" in the top navigation bar.

Adding a New Client

1 Click "+ New Client"

The bright blue button in the top-right of the CRM page opens a new client form.

2 Fill in client details

Name is required. Add contact info, address, source (how you found them), and any initial tags (e.g., "Residential", "Repeat Customer").

3 Set the status

Choose the pipeline status: Prospect (new inquiry), Active (ongoing work), Completed, On-Hold, or Declined.

4 Save

Click "Save Client" to add them to your CRM.

Client Pipeline Statuses

- Prospect (blue) — A lead or potential customer. Has not yet committed.
- Active (green) — A current client with work underway or accepted quote.
- Completed (purple) — Project is finished. Good candidate for review requests and repeat business outreach.
- On-Hold (yellow) — Project paused. Check in periodically.
- Declined (red) — Client did not move forward. Useful to track loss reasons.

Client Profile

Click any client name to open their full profile, which includes:

- Contact Information — All contact details you entered, with quick-dial and email links
- Estimate History — Every estimate linked to this client with amounts, status, and dates
- Notes Timeline — Chronological log of all notes added to this client
- Total Value — Lifetime value of all estimates/invoices associated with this client
- Source — How you acquired this client (walk-in, referral, website, etc.)

Adding Notes

1 Open a client profile

Click the client's name from the CRM list.

2 Click "Add Note"

A text input appears at the top of the notes timeline.

3

Type your note

Notes can be any length. Use them for: follow-up reminders, meeting summaries, client preferences, special instructions, or complaint logs.

4

Click "Save Note"

The note is saved with a timestamp and appears at the top of the timeline.

Searching & Filtering Clients

- Search Bar — Type any part of a client's name, company, email, or phone to filter the list instantly.
- Status Filter — Click a status badge at the top of the CRM to show only clients with that status.
- Sort — Click column headers to sort by name, date added, or total value.

11. The "Need a Website?" Feature

TTC includes a built-in lead generation tool for XpertAISolution.com web design services. A floating "Need a Website?" button appears at the bottom-right corner of every app page.

!9 INFO

This feature is entirely optional. It opens an interest form for business owners who want a professional website. Your data is never shared or sold.

1

Click "Need a Website?"

A modal dialog opens with information about web design services starting from \$1,200.

2

Click "Get a Free Quote"

Advances to the interest form. (Click "Maybe Later" to close without submitting anything.)

3

Answer "Use current details?"

Choose whether to use your existing business profile details (pre-fills the form) or enter different information for the website.

4

Upload your logo and photos

Upload your company logo and up to 5 business photos that you want featured on the website.

5

Select your style preferences

Choose a design style (Modern, Classic, Bold, or Minimal), preferred colors, budget range, and desired timeline.

6

Submit

Your interest form is submitted securely. The XpertAISolution.com team will reach out within 24 hours.

12. Upgrading Your Plan

TTC offers three plan tiers. You can upgrade at any time from within the app.

Feature	Free	Pro	Enterprise
Feature	Free	Pro	Enterprise
Estimates per month	3	Unlimited	Unlimited
PDF Export	✓	✓	✓
Word Export (.docx)	—	✓	✓
3-Tier pricing	✓	✓	✓
Auto-populate formulas (18 types)	✓	✓	✓
Company Settings & Logo	✓	✓	✓
Convert Estimate to Invoice	✓	✓	✓
CRM — Client Management	—	✓	✓
CRM — Notes & Timeline	—	✓	✓
Estimate History in CRM	—	✓	✓
Team Members	—	—	✓
Priority Support	—	—	✓
Admin Command Center	—	—	✓

Free Plan: \$0/month — Up to 3 estimates

Pro Plan: \$29/month — Unlimited estimates + full CRM

Enterprise: \$79/month — Everything + team members + priority support

TIP

To upgrade, sign in and look for the "Upgrade" prompt in the app, or contact support at support@xpertaisolution.com.

13. Getting Help

If you have questions not covered in this guide, here are your support options:

- Email Support — support@xpertaisolution.com (all plans)
- Priority Email — Faster response times for Enterprise plan users
- Website — xpertaisolution.com for the latest updates and announcements
- Admin note: If you did not receive this guide via email, log in and use the "Resend Guide" button in your account settings, or contact support.

!9 INFO

TTC Estimator is actively developed. New project types, features, and integrations are added regularly. Watch for in-app notifications for new updates.